millionaires' in the country. It also noted the unequal distribution of wealth with 72.8 per cent of Indian adults owning less than $1,00,000 of assets/wealth; the global average is about 56 per cent.

Forbes magazine publishes a list of global billionaires virtually on a real-time basis on its dashboard. At the end of 2020, there were four Indian billionaires in the top 100, eight in the top 200, thirteen in the top 300, sixteen in the top 400, twenty-two in the top 500, forty-two in the top 1000, sixty-seven in the top 1500, ninety-five in the top 2000, and 118 in the entire list of about 2250 billionaires. India's fairly large presence in the list also vindicates GWR 2020's conclusion of excessive inequality.

Bloomberg, too, publishes a list of the top 500 global billionaires, which is also updated on a real-time basis. This list is similar to the *Forbes* list with only some minor variations. As per this list, the number of Indian billionaires at the end of December 2020 was nineteen.

No Indian institution, official or unofficial, provides estimates of the wealth of India and Indians.

What is Driving Global Wealth Creation?

Primarily, two forces drive wealth creation. First, savings from the current income invested in real productive assets to grow incomes or save expenditures (factories, infrastructure, house property). Second, credit creation by central banks and banking companies. Central banks conduct monetary policies in a manner that releases additional currency and reserve money in the system, which helps banking and other depository institutions create credit to enable businesses and households to invest in productive assets. A good part of household savings also becomes available to businesses and investors, directly or through intermediation of financial institutions, to be invested in equities. Most of the banking system's support reaches businesses as debt. Together, debt and equity help create productive assets, which build national wealth.